

Control No 25-017:

Contractor: Carahsoft Technology Corporation

Supply/Service: Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses
and Support Services

Est Dollar Value: [REDACTED]

**JUSTIFICATION REVIEW DOCUMENT
FOR EXCEPTION TO FAIR OPPORTUNITY**

Supply/Service: Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses and Support Services

Authority: Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B)

[REDACTED]

Contracting Officer: Ward N. Robinson PN: 520-693-1338
Contracting Officer
Email: ward.n.robinson.civ@army.mil

[REDACTED]

Reviews: I have reviewed this justification and find it adequate to support an exception to fair opportunity.

[REDACTED]

Controlled by: Army
Controlled by: ACC-RI TGD
CUI Category: SSEL
Distribution Statement or LDC B

[REDACTED]

Contractor: Carahsoft Technology Corporation
Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses
and Support Services

Est Dollar Value: [REDACTED]

**Department of the Army
Justification for Exception to Fair Opportunity
Under Multiple Award Indefinite Delivery Contracts**

1. Contracting Activity: U.S. Army Contracting Command – Rock Island (ACC-RI), Rock Island Arsenal, Rock Island, IL 61299-8000.

2. Description of Action: United States Military Academy (USMA) requests a firm-fixed-price task order with Carahsoft Technology Corporation (Carahsoft). ACC-RI will execute this action under Computer Hardware, Enterprise Software, and Solutions (CHESS) Information Technology Enterprise Solutions – Software 2 (ITES-SW2) Contract W52P1J-20-D-0042. ACC-RI projects award for no later than [REDACTED] and will use fiscal year [REDACTED] Army Working Capital Funds. An acquisition plan is not required because this procurement does not meet the threshold at Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement 207.103(d)(i)(B).

3. Description of Supplies/Services: USMA has requirements for the Qualtrics Design Experience Management (Design XM) Enterprise Software as a Service (SaaS) license subscription and ancillary services in support of the USMA at West Point and its defense-oriented research in order to better understand the Army's fighting force.

The Qualtrics Design XM SaaS is a comprehensive tool designed for large organizations to create, distribute, and analyze surveys at scale. The Design XM Enterprise platform is used to gather feedback from customers, employees, and Cadets, helping the Academy make data-driven decisions and improve various aspects of their operations. The Qualtrics Design XM license subscriptions consist of an internet-accessible survey platform, which allows authorized users to create surveys, distribute surveys and collect responses, conduct analysis of survey responses, and create reports and deliverables based on data collected and analysis conducted. Additionally, this requirement includes ancillary services to assist end users create surveys that collect the right types of data, ensures surveys are clear and concise, and provides support in creating analytical products. These services are available to all authorized users of the Qualtrics platform.

[REDACTED]

USMA estimates a total value of [REDACTED], including options, based on the Independent Government Estimate.

4. Authority Cited: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B). Only one awardee is capable of providing the supplies or services required at the level of quality required because the supplies or services ordered are unique or highly specialized.

5. Reason for Authority Cited: Since 2022, USMA utilized Qualtrics to meet its need to conduct wide ranging surveys both internal to the USMA as well as across the Army. Some of the most common surveys conducted include assessments of cadet climate and leadership development, evaluations of academic program effectiveness, and critical surveys related to sexual harassment/assault prevention and response.

The surveys conducted by USMA include Personally Identifiable Information (PII), Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI), or Human Subjects Research (HSR), which requires Federal Risk and Authorization Management Program (FedRAMP) Moderate accredited security protections. FedRAMP Moderate accreditation is essential because it is a DoD mandated security requirement for cloud systems handling sensitive data like PII, CUI, and HSR as outlined in the DoD Cloud Security Requirements Guide (SRG), and Information Technology Army Regulation (AR) 25-1. FedRAMP is a standardized approach to security assessment, authorization, and continuous monitoring for cloud products and services that handle federal data. This accreditation verifies that the Qualtrics Design XM software meets rigorous security standards to protect against data breaches and ensures compliance with stringent DoD regulations. Furthermore, as noted in paragraph 6 below, USMA's review in FedRAMP Marketplace revealed Qualtrics continues to be the only FedRAMP Moderate accredited enterprise survey platform available in the marketplace and therefore the only product that can meet the requirements of this acquisition.

Additionally, Qualtrics is the only product that can satisfy this requirement based on its unique capabilities which include:

- **Robust Survey Design and Distribution:** Qualtrics has the ability to create complex surveys with diverse question types (e.g., Likert scales, open-ended responses, and multimedia), branching logic (directing respondents to different questions based on their answers), and multimedia elements (images and videos) to enhance engagement and data richness. The platform also allows for efficient distribution to large and targeted audiences (e.g., specific cadet

companies, academic departments, or alumni groups) using various methods (e.g., email and web links).

- **Advanced Data Analysis and Reporting:** Qualtrics has tools to analyze survey data in-depth, including descriptive statistics, cross-tabulations, trend analysis, and sentiment analysis. It can also generate custom reports with data visualizations (e.g., charts, graphs, and dashboards) and allows for the export of findings in various formats (e.g., Comma-Separated Values (CSV), Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS), and Excel) for further analysis and decision-making.
- **Secure Data Storage and Handling:** Qualtrics meets stringent security standards because it possesses a FedRAMP Moderate authorization as mandated by DoD security regulations (DoD Cloud SRG and AR 25-1) to ensure adequate protection of sensitive data.
- **Seamless Integration:** Qualtrics already integrates with USMA's existing Information Technology (IT) infrastructure, particularly the West Point Research and Education Network for user authentication and authorization via Single Sign-On. This integration ensures that only authorized USMA personnel can access the platform and that user accounts are managed through the Academy's central system.

Leveraging Qualtrics's capabilities of complex workflows and functionalities are integral to USMA's existing processes.

- **Longitudinal Studies and Tracking Cadet Development:** USMA conducts longitudinal studies tracking cadet progress over time, from admission to graduation and beyond. Qualtrics can support this by:
 - **Panel Management:** Managing groups of respondents (cadet cohorts) and sending them surveys at specific intervals (e.g., annually, at key milestones).
 - **Data Linking and Analysis:** Merging data from multiple surveys across time to track individual and cohort-level trends in leadership development, academic performance, well-being, and career outcomes.
 - **Automated Reporting:** Generating reports that visualize changes over time and highlight areas for intervention or program improvement.
- **Climate Assessments and Intervention Programs:** USMA uses surveys to assess organizational climate related to sexual harassment/assault or leadership culture. Qualtrics can facilitate:
 - **Anonymous Feedback Collection:** Ensuring respondent confidentiality to encourage honest and candid responses.
 - **Branching Logic:** Tailoring survey questions based on initial responses to delve deeper into specific issues or concerns.

- Real-Time Reporting and Alerts: Identifying potential problems early on and triggering automated notifications to appropriate personnel for intervention or support.
- Academic Program Evaluation and Improvement: USMA has processes for evaluating course effectiveness, gathering student and faculty feedback, and making data-driven curriculum decisions. Qualtrics can support:
 - Course Evaluations: Distributing standardized course evaluations, collecting both quantitative and qualitative feedback, and generating reports for individual instructors and academic departments.
 - Program Review Data Collection: Integrating survey data with other performance metrics to provide a holistic view of program strengths and weaknesses.
 - Collaboration and Action Planning: Facilitating collaboration among faculty and administrators to develop action plans based on survey insights.

Furthermore, switching platforms would introduce significant delays that would directly hinder USMA's ability to fulfill its research mission. Even if a comparable alternative survey platform were to begin the process today, it would face a lengthy and multi-stage path to becoming available for USMA's procurement. Achieving FedRAMP Moderate authorization typically takes at least [REDACTED] and involves a readiness assessment, a rigorous third-party security assessment, and federal authorization. Following that, the vendor would then need to secure a place on a mandatory source contract vehicle, such as DoD Enterprise Software Initiative (ESI) or CHES, a process that typically adds at least another [REDACTED] including contract competition and compliance requirements. Given these extensive timelines, it is highly improbable that a suitable alternative to Qualtrics could be procured competitively within a timeframe that meets USMA's pressing requirements, resulting in significant disruptions to critical research and data collection efforts.

As stated below in paragraph 6, market research has demonstrated that Carahsoft is the only authorized reseller within CHES ITES-SW2 that can provide the Qualtrics Design XM brand name. As CHES ITES-SW2 is the mandatory source for all commercial IT requirements per Army Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement 5139.101-90(a)(1), Carahsoft is the only vendor capable of providing Qualtrics Design XM to USMA. Furthermore, Carahsoft has been successfully providing this software to the USMA since 2022.

- [REDACTED]
- **Compromised Decision-Making:** The lack of timely and reliable data would force USMA leadership to make decisions based on incomplete or outdated information, potentially jeopardizing the effectiveness of academic programs, training initiatives, and force development strategies.
- **Inability to Fulfill Army Requirements:** USMA would be unable to provide the Army with essential data and analysis to inform strategic decisions, impacting force modernization efforts, policy development, and resource allocation.
- **Reputational Damage:** Publicly acknowledging an inability to conduct essential research due to inadequate technology could damage USMA's reputation as a leading military academic institution.

6. Market Research: Market research was conducted by USMA between June and October 2024. Searches were conducted across multiple government databases, including the Interagency Contract Directory, General Services Administration Advantage, and SAM.gov. Additionally, USMA reviewed FedRAMP Marketplace, which is a publicly available database of cloud service offerings that have achieved a FedRAMP authorization and is a crucial review for government agencies seeking to procure secure and compliant cloud solutions. These searches aimed to identify similar products that possessed a FedRAMP Moderate impact level authorization. USMA found no alternative products other than Qualtrics Design XM that possessed a FedRAMP Moderate impact level authorization. Additionally, mandatory source contract vehicles for the DoD, including DoD ESI and CHES, were examined to determine which contract vehicle offered Qualtrics Design XM and found it was available in DoD ESI and CHES ITES-SW2.

USMA also analyzed alternative solutions to see if those products' capabilities would meet the specific requirements of the USMA. The findings below highlight the shortcomings of these alternatives, particularly regarding FedRAMP Moderate authorization and integration capabilities:

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Based on the market research, Carahsoft is the only authorized Qualtrics reseller that can provide Qualtrics Design XM software via its CHESS ITES-SW2 Contract. Furthermore, since CHESS is a mandatory source contract vehicle for the Army, Carahsoft is the only vendor capable of fulfilling USMA's requirement.

7. Actions to Increase Competition: The Government will work to increase competition for follow-on requirements by conducting market research to determine if there are any changes in the marketplace, such as additional brand name Qualtrics resellers within the Army's mandatory source contract vehicles or alternative products that possess a FedRAMP Moderate impact level authorization, that will allow for competition.

8. Other Facts:

Procurement History:

Contract: W52P1J-20-D-0042/W52P1J-22-F-4040

Contractor: Carahsoft Technology Corp.

Award Date: 01 March 2022

Competitive Status: Unknown.

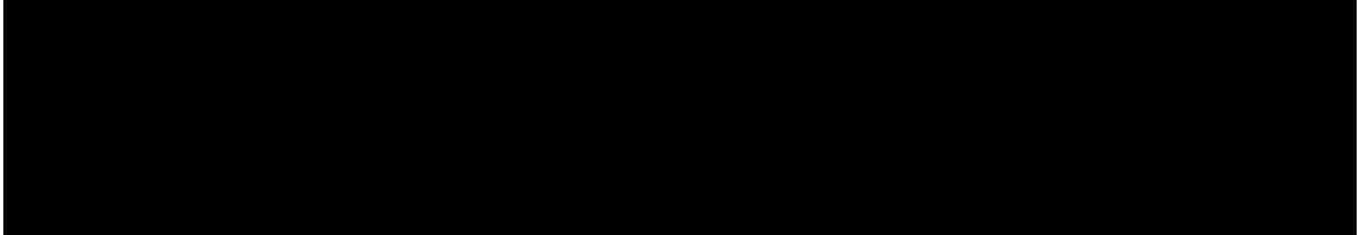
Despite a thorough review of procurement records, a formal justification document could not be located.

Contractor: Carahsoft Technology Corporation

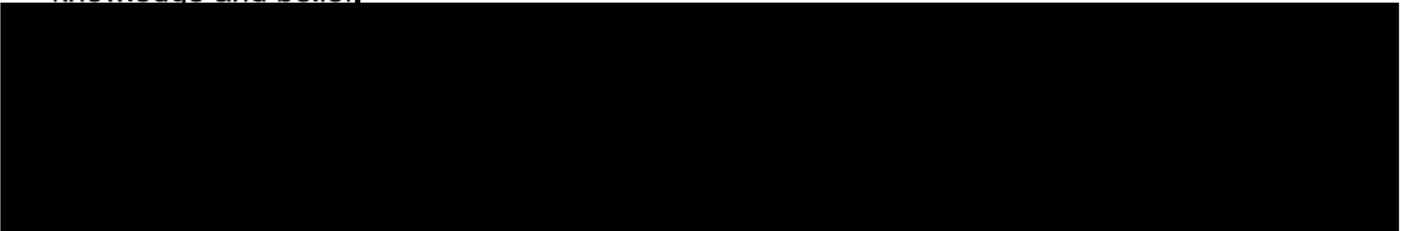
Supply/Service: Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses
and Support Services

Est Dollar Value: [REDACTED]

9. Technical Certification: I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.



10. Requirements Certification: I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.



11. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination: I hereby determine that the anticipated cost or price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable via price analysis. The determination will base on comparison of proposed prices against Carahsoft's published price lists and past procurements for the same or similar services. Certified cost or pricing data will not be required, as this is a commercially available service as per FAR 15.403-1(b)(3).

Date: _____

ROBINSON.WARD.NI
CHOLAS.1148551975

Digitally signed by
ROBINSON.WARD.NICHOLAS.11
48551975
Date: 2025.02.26 14:05:59 -06'00'

WARD N. ROBINSON
Contracting Officer

12. Contracting Officer Certification: I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Date: _____

ROBINSON.WARD.NI
CHOLAS.1148551975

Digitally signed by
ROBINSON.WARD.NICHOLAS.1
148551975
Date: 2025.02.26 14:06:15 -06'00'

WARD N. ROBINSON
Contracting Officer

Contractor: Carahsoft Technology Corporation

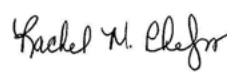
Supply/Service: Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses
and Support Services

Est Dollar Value: [REDACTED]

Approval

Based on the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Qualtrics Design XM Software Subscription Licenses and Support Services using an exception to fair opportunity pursuant to the authority of FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B), subject to availability of funds, and provided that the services or supplies herein described have otherwise been authorized for acquisition.

Date: 27 FEB 2025



Digitally signed by
PHELPS,RACHEL.M.1258319865
Date: 2025.02.27 16:19:36 -06'00'

RACHEL M. PHELPS
Competition Advocate